ACCOUNT EXECUTIVE ONBOARDING · NOVEMBER 2026

# Welcome to Appear, *Stefan.*

How we make businesses show up in AI answers, who we sell to, every motion that feeds the pipeline, and how you will run outbound from day one.

Prepared by Grischa Bauguitte, Marketing and GTM



Internal. Do not forward.

WHY WE EXIST

# The web now has two kinds of visitors. *Most websites only serve one.*

Buyers ask ChatGPT, Perplexity, Gemini and Claude who to hire. The AI picks a handful of businesses and names them. If it cannot read you, you are not on the list, however good the human site is.

**73%**

of B2B buyers already use AI tools in their research.

B2B SaaS Citation Benchmarks Report, 2026

**60%**

of searches now end without a click, because the answer is given directly.

Bain and Company, 2025

**80%**

of URLs cited by AI sit outside Google's top 100. Ranking on Google is not the same game.

Ahrefs, 2025

**14.2%**

conversion from AI search versus 2.8% from Google. Buyers arrive pre sold.

Superprompt, 12M visit study



Only use stats from the approved list. Never round them differently.

WHAT YOU SELL

# Trackers show the gap. *Appear closes it.*

We build the content AI needs to recommend a business, serve it to AI crawlers from the business's own domain with one DNS record, and track the leads it brings in.

- **One CNAME record.** No plugin, no code, no CMS migration. Works on Framer, Webflow, WordPress, Shopify, Next.js and custom stacks.
- **Agent Website.** AI crawlers get structured content (Markdown, schema, FAQs, entities). People and Googlebot get the normal site, untouched.
- **Approved facts.** The customer approves what AI receives before it goes live.
- **New answers.** We create content for the questions buyers in that industry ask AI.
- **Proof.** Crawler analytics plus an attribution pixel on bookings, forms and calls. When ROI comes up, lead with the pixel.

VISITOR ARRIVES

**Appear detects who it is at the DNS edge**

Human, search crawler or AI crawler, in real time.

**Humans and Googlebot**

See the website exactly as designed. SEO stack untouched.

**AI crawlers**

Receive the clean, structured Agent Website built from approved facts.

**If a customer cancels**

Remove the record and routing goes back to normal. What AI already learned may stay. No new improvements reach new crawls.

Show, do not tell: on calls, toggle the human view and the AI view of joinappear.com live. It is the strongest moment in the demo.



Source: AE Role and Context, Battle Cards (Oct 2026), joinappear.com

PACKAGING

# Priced per domain, per month. *Three month minimum,* then monthly.

STANDARD

## $2,500

per domain per month

Audit and technical setup, schema and entities, AI readable version of every page, monthly refresh, monthly reports and competitor tracking.

**Results target: 60 to 90 days**

GROWTH

## $3,500

per domain per month

Everything in Standard plus bi weekly refresh, topic architecture, new content, citation building and advanced competitor intelligence.

**Results target: 45 to 60 days**

ENTERPRISE

## $5,000

per domain per month

Everything in Growth plus weekly refresh, dedicated account manager, priority support and a custom reporting dashboard.

**Results target: 30 to 45 days**

**Negotiate on value, not discounts.** If a buyer asks for a lower price, ask which capability or outcome they would give up. Proposal goes out only after the champion confirms we solve the problem.

**Price is never quoted by cold email.** It is covered on the call. Self serve entry plans are being defined and are not live yet. We no longer sell website builds or social.



Source: AE Role and Context, Battle Cards. Ads setup occasionally sold as its own line item.

WHO WE SELL TO

# High ticket, location based businesses *whose website drives leads.*

### Best fit verticals

Strongest in healthcare, legal, home and professional services, and insurance.

PI law | DSOs | Med spas | HVAC | Fertility | Franchise networks | Private schools

### Segment is size, not vertical

**SMB:** 1 to 500 employees, up to $2.5K MRR.
**Enterprise:** 500+ employees, above $2.5K MRR.

### Who is in the room

- **The owner or marketing lead** who feels the pain and becomes your champion.
- **The economic buyer** who wants the number, the cost and the payback. Keep it short.
- **Whoever owns the website and DNS.** They must be in the scoping call or the deal stalls at setup.
- **The incumbent agency.** Position us as infrastructure under their strategy, never a replacement.

### Website signals worth acting on

- No schema markup
- Content rendered client side with JavaScript
- robots.txt blocking AI crawlers
- Several locations or domains (we price per domain)

**Not for AEs:** marketing and SEO agencies go to the partner program, owned by Kien.



Source: AE Role and Context, ICP

THE MOTIONS

# Six ways pipeline reaches us. *Know which one a lead came from* before you open your mouth.

| MOTION | HOW IT WORKS | WHERE IT LANDS | YOUR JOB |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Appear cold email**<br>Instantly, US local SMB | "We asked ChatGPT for the best [niche] in [city]. It named three competitors, not you." CTA: reply "show me". Live mixes: medical, home services, flooring. | Echo, our reply agent, answers and sends the real ChatGPT result, then books into Appear Intro. | Run the booked call. Rebook no shows the same day. |
| **The Rank Collective outbound**<br>Instantly, US owner led SMB | About 10,000 emails a month from 30 TRC inboxes to about 5,000 owners. Financial advisors, med spas, real estate, luxury travel. Offer: free strategy call. | TRC Intro calendar, round robin to Rocky and Jordon. Goal 30 to 50 calls a month. | Know the brand line (next slide). Never cross inboxes. |
| **LinkedIn and AE outbound**<br>Your book, lemlist, calls | Researched prospects from your named book and open pool. Sequences plus calls in Power Hours. | Deal enters HubSpot at Appointment Scheduled. | **This is your core motion.** Built on the next slides. |
| **Inbound**<br>Meta lead ads, audit requests | Meta Instant Forms and free AI audit requests post to the sales inbound channel in Slack with site and CRM link. | Owner of the book, or round robin for open pool. | Reply the same business day. Read the audit before the call. |
| **Partners**<br>Agencies and resellers | Agencies resell or refer Appear under the partner program. | Kien. Partner registered accounts are protected for 60 days. | Route agencies to Kien. Check before you prospect. |
| **Self serve**<br>Coming, not live | Lower priced entry plans with a free audit up front. | Stays in product until it hits the PQL definition, then routes like inbound. | Work PQLs once live. Deal is created when the CNAME is verified. |



Source: Slack GTM and outbound agent channels (Nov 2026), Sales Playbook, AE Role and Context

TWO BRANDS, ONE ENGINE

# Appear is the platform. *The Rank Collective* is our GEO agency brand.

APPEAR

### The software and the managed service

Sold per domain on Standard, Growth and Enterprise. AE owned, HubSpot pipeline, Appear Intro calendar, PandaDoc contracts. Your outbound runs under this brand.

- Mid market and multi location buyers
- Proof: crawler analytics, pixel, case studies on joinappear.com

THE RANK COLLECTIVE

### White glove AEO and GEO for owner led SMBs

Same core idea, sold as an agency relationship with a strategist. Own domain, own inboxes, own calendar, TRC Pipeline in GoHighLevel, its own SMB call playbook.

- Owners who want it done for them, not a platform
- Proof: their ChatGPT answer and their reviews next to a competitor's

**The one hard rule.** Never mix the brands on a lead. An Appear lead is never contacted from a TRC inbox, and a TRC lead never gets an Appear signature. If a lead sits in the wrong place, flag it in Slack instead of replying.



Source: Our Products, Pricing and Logic, Reply Agent Playbook

YOUR OUTBOUND ENGINE

# Research, enrich, personalise, sequence, call. *One goal: a booked video call.*

LISTS

**Build by segment**

Sales Navigator, Clay or Apify. Name, company, domain, LinkedIn, segment.

→

ENRICH

**Find and verify**

Waterfall: Leadmagic, Icypeas, Prospeo, Findymail. Verified with MillionVerifier.

→

PERSONALISE

**One real line**

An opener per prospect tied to their site, city or competitors. Never a template feel.

→

SEQUENCE

**Email and LinkedIn**

Instantly for email on warmed domains, lemlist for LinkedIn connection and DM steps.

→

CALL

**Book, do not pitch**

Cold calls follow 30MPC's Cold Calling Sucks framework. The only win is a meeting.

## Your book

Each AE owns a named book, balanced across verticals, tiers and markets. One owner per domain. If HubSpot and the sheet disagree, HubSpot wins.

## Open pool claims

Up to 15 a month. Set yourself as owner and log a meaningful activity the same day. A sequence enrolment alone does not count. Rules marked proposed may still change.

## Keep it alive

No meaningful activity in 45 days flags the account. At 60 days it returns to the pool. An open opportunity protects it. Write territory plan V1 in onboarding.



Source: Outbound Process, AE Role and Context, Book of Business rules

THE HOOK THAT WORKS

# Do not tell them they are invisible. *Show them who AI recommends instead.*

THE PATTERN FROM OUR LIVE CAMPAIGNS

*"We asked ChatGPT for the best dentist in Austin. It named three practices. You were not one of them, and one of them has a third of your reviews."*

Call to action: reply "show me". Then send the real answer as proof before asking for any time.

- **It is specific and checkable.** They can run the same question themselves in ten seconds.
- **It names competitors.** Losing to a rival creates urgency that "AI is the future" never will.
- **It is a proof artifact that travels.** The owner forwards it to a partner without needing us in the room.
- **It answers the hardest SPICED gap.** AI visibility has no natural deadline. A competitor being named today is the deadline.
- **Send more info means send the screenshot,** not a deck. Documents get buried.



Example wording is illustrative. Source: Reply Agent Playbook, TRC outbound brief

RUNNING THE DEAL

# Stages move on *exit criteria,* not on a good call.

| CALL | WHAT HAS TO HAPPEN |
|---|---|
| **Frame** | Set the agenda, hand them the floor, "let's see if it is a fit". |
| **Discovery** | Acquisition channels, what a customer is worth, paid spend, who they lose to. Write competitor names down. |
| **Pitch** | Two things we do: make the site readable to every AI model, and win the questions buyers ask. Tie it to what they just said. |
| **Show** | Human view versus AI view live, then queries, citations and competitor tracking. Use their rival's name. |
| **Close** | Offer the next step, then stop talking. |

### Frameworks

**Command of the Message** shapes every conversation: before scenario, after scenario, cost of doing nothing, required capabilities, metrics, approved proof.

**BANT** as a light pass at Appointment Scheduled. **MEDDPICC** from Discovery on, starting with Metrics, Economic Buyer, Decision Process and Champion.

### House rules

Ask a question every two to three minutes. Use their words. Talk 45 to 55 percent of the call. Proposal only after acceptance. Contracts in PandaDoc. If it is not in HubSpot, it did not happen.



Source: AE Role and Context, SMB Playbook, Call Structure

OBJECTIONS

# The six you will hear in week one.

### "IS THIS CLOAKING?"

Cloaking means showing Google something different to game Google. Googlebot gets the normal site. AI crawlers get a structured version of the same approved facts. Answer it directly, never dodge it.

### "WE ALREADY DO SEO"

Keep doing it. SEO is for Google. AI engines read and pick businesses differently, which is why most AI cited pages sit outside Google's top 100. The two work together.

### "WE USE PROFOUND / A TRACKER"

Good, use it as our scorecard. Trackers report the gap. Appear changes what AI receives and hosts it. We include competitor tracking anyway.

### "WHY $2,500 WHEN TOOLS COST $99?"

Tools report, we fix and host. Rebuild the maths with their own cost per lead and customer value from discovery. Then negotiate on value, not discount.

### "CAN YOU GUARANTEE RESULTS?"

Nobody controls what AI says. We control what AI crawlers receive and we measure it. Plans target measurable results in 30 to 90 days depending on tier.

### "YOU'RE SMALL"

True, we are young. The risk of trying is low: one DNS record, nothing changes on the site, remove it to undo. Never claim a certification we do not hold.

PROOF YOU CAN USE

# Published results. *Quote them exactly as written.*

SAAS · RETELL AI

## 36 of 40

buyer questions tested across four AI engines named or cited Retell.

BANKING · 200 LOCAL BANKS

## 11% → 58%

named answers in 12 weeks after publishing public condition pages.

HOME SERVICES · DERBY STRONG

## 18% → 34%

same question mention from April to August. AI crawler hits up 2.4x.

HEALTHCARE · THE SEE CLINIC

## 67%

of August Perplexity answers named the clinic. AI crawler hits up 2.7x.

FITNESS · FETTLE

## 69%

of August ChatGPT answers named Fettle, 49% cited it.

HVAC · COPELAND, TEXAS

## Missing → named

April 2026 absent from the answer. September 2026 named and cited, via its emergency AC repair page.

Rule: only claims published on the joinappear.com case studies page or approved by Marketing go to buyers. These show visibility, not revenue. Do not present them as lead or revenue guarantees.



Source: joinappear.com case studies page, read 9 Nov 2026

HOW YOU ARE MEASURED

# Volume gets you meetings. *Conversion gets you paid.*

| PIPELINE MATHS | ILLUSTRATIVE |
|---|---|
| Monthly target | $10,000 new MRR |
| Deals needed at $2,500 | 4 |
| Meetings held at 15% close | 27 |
| Meetings booked at 75% show | 36 |
| Qualified pipeline at 4x | $40,000 |

Meeting to close was 6% in May 2026. At that rate the same target needs about 67 held meetings. Quality matters as much as volume.

### Benchmarks

Coverage 3.5x to 4x next month. Win rate 25%. Meeting to close 15%. Show rate 70 to 80%. SMB cycle under 10 days. Below 3x coverage, Power Hours go to new pipeline.

### Ramp gates

**Day 5** pitch in two minutes, five objections, pricing, ICP. **Day 10** discovery role play and demo. **Day 20** independent selling. **Day 30** first solo close signed or in Commit, 4x pipeline. **Day 90** fully ramped and forecasting.

YOUR WEEK AND YOUR PEOPLE

# Same rhythm for every AE. *Ask anyone, anytime.*

| WHEN | WHAT |
|---|---|
| **Daily** | Start up 09:00 local. Sales Daily 15:30 UK. Close out 18:00 with calls logged, MEDDPICC and next steps updated. |
| **Monday** | Pipeline Review |
| **Tuesday, Thursday** | Power Hours for research, calls and sequences |
| **Wednesday** | Deal Review and coaching |
| **Thursday** | Forecast Review |
| **Friday** | 1:1 |

### Kien Huynh, CRO

Your manager. Runs team rituals, joins deals on request or above his size threshold, owns the partner program.

### Grischa Bauguitte, Marketing and GTM

Campaigns, outbound engine, approved claims and proof. Bring lead quality feedback to the monthly sync.

### Alykhan Kara, Product and platform

Product training, platform, Stripe and PandaDoc access. Send product insights from calls here.

### Rocky Keller and Jordon Bediako, AEs

Shadow at least five of their discovery and demo calls in week one.



Source: AE Operating Cadence, AE Role and Context

WHAT GREAT LOOKS LIKE

# We are proving one repeatable motion. *You are part of the proof.*

### Can it work without a founder in the room?

If you close at the same rate as the team without Kien or Grischa on the call, the motion travels. That is the whole game right now.

### Write down what works

You are hired to sell and to sharpen the playbook. Every winning opener, objection answer and lost reason goes back into it.

### Think past the signature

Expansion lives in more domains and higher tiers. Multi location buyers are the best first deals for exactly that reason.

First step today: tools, Sales Space in Notion, and your first five shadow calls in the calendar.